

PhonePact — Reddit → Ad Copy

Three sub-audiences, three psychological profiles, fifteen 10-second video hooks

Built 29 July 2026 using the Marcus Burke "Reddit → Ad Copy" workflow.

0. What this is built on

Threads mined	1,995 high-engagement posts
Comments mined	6,205 verbatim comment bodies
Subreddits	46
Engagement floor	25+ upvotes; top threads 1,000–4,000 ¹ with 100–855 comments
Method	8 parallel miners (one per audience slice) → segmentation → 3 copywriters → 2 adversarial verifiers

Access note: reddit.com is blocked to both the standard web crawler and the browser tool, so collection ran through the Arctic Shift and PullPush Reddit archives — real threads, real scores, rate-limited to ~1 request/3s.

Verification: every quote below was re-checked with a literal string search against the corpus files. Quotes that could not be located were cut, and three fabrications the copywriters introduced were caught and removed (detailed in §5). **Every quotation in this document is real.**

1. THE EMPTY ROOM

Remote workers, devs and solo builders who discovered they were never disciplined — just observed

One line: They figured out that the only thing that ever stopped them scrolling was another human being in the room. Then that human went away.

Who: 22–40. Works from home or hybrid. Developer, designer, analyst, grad student, solo founder. Lives on the device for work, so removing the phone is not an option. Diagnoses their own behavior like an engineer — *loop, friction, reflex, autopilot*. They were fine in the office. They are not fine now.

The core wound

The office had someone sitting next to them, and *that person* — not discipline — was what kept them working. Now nobody is watching, and it turns out they were never disciplined at all. They were just observed. **Admitting that feels like discovering they have no self.**

"While I was in the office I sat next to my boss so that kept me very accountable. Now a whole day can go by and I feel like I got nothing done."

— r/workfromhome

"I have no one looking over my shoulder like I would at the office."

— r/workfromhome

Biggest pains

1. **They hold their own key.** Every lock they install, they unlock — at 11pm, by a weaker version of themselves.
2. **The reach happens before the decision does.** "I sit down to code or study, and within 5 minutes, my hand automatically reaches for the phone."
3. **The dashboard is a receipt, not an intervention.** It arrives after the damage, produces revulsion, changes nothing.
4. **It isn't even fun anymore.** "The scary part is that I don't even enjoy scrolling anymore. I just keep doing it automatically." / "It stopped being fun a long time ago and turned into pure reflex."
5. **Nobody treats it as real.** Say your screen time is out of control and people say "same" and laugh. So they carry it alone.
6. **Career dread.** The deliverable is late, the interview is in two weeks, and the day already went.

Self-diagnostic buzzwords

brain rot · cooked · fried / dopamine receptors fried · doom scrolling · autopilot · pure reflex · popcorn brain · fake tired · the loop · stuck in this loop · brain is not braining · overstimulated · shell of a human · goldfish-level attention span · chokehold

How they write (mirror these patterns)

- **Timestamped numeric confession.** An exact figure offered as evidence against themselves: *"9 hours 43 minutes."*
- **Failed-solution litany in rhythm.** Three attempts, three one-line defeats, no commentary.
- **Lowercase self-contempt.** No capitals, no punctuation — muttered rather than posted.

- **Engineer-register self-diagnosis.** They explain the mechanism instead of complaining: *"a promise is you vs you at your weakest moment. friction is just physics."*
- **Confessional aside that pre-empts judgment:** "not proud of it but that's the truth", "lol", "I guess".
- **Second-person universalizing** at the end of a personal confession, to check if anyone else is like this.

Current state → Desired state

Now: 11–14 hours screen time on a working day. Sits down to work, phone in hand within five minutes with no memory of picking it up. Scrolling is pure reflex on content they cannot recall.

Wants: Not monk mode. Not a dumbphone. **The office back, without the office** — a reason to stay conscious, so a working day produces work and an evening feels like rest.

What they already tried

Apple Screen Time ("I turn it off in mo[ments]") · deleting apps ("i legit uninstalled insta like 4 times n still ended [up back]") · one-sec-style delay apps (desensitized) · grayscale (lasted two days) · phone across the room (they got up and got it) · **a friend holding a passcode — the closest thing to a social solution, and it failed because it was built as a lock:**

"I even had a friend set a secret passcode, but I used the 'Forgot Passcode' option to reset it to bypass the restrictions."

— r/productivity

Objections you must clear

1. **Surveillance recoil** — loudest objection in this slice. They will not hand a coworker a window into their day.
2. **Autonomy above all** — *"I'm too attached to my free will (aka screen addiction)."* They refuse hard blockers on principle. A product that takes agency is dead on arrival.
3. **Category fatigue** — *"no blocker tool was ever going to fix my phone addiction."*
4. **Mechanic scepticism** — *"it's a text message? That's it?"* The Café Effect must be **shown**, not asserted.
5. **Social cost of asking** — putting someone in your circle means admitting it out loud to a named human.
6. **"Will they see what I was doing?"** Until *never which apps* is explicit, they assume the worst.

Why PhonePact fits

This is the only segment that **independently derived PhonePact's thesis and then complained the product doesn't exist**. They don't need the Café Effect explained — they lived it and lost it. *"I have no one looking over my shoulder like I would at the office"* is the product brief.

Market evidence: r/workfromhome *"I can't get off my phone when working from home — how do you keep yourself accountable?"* — **645↑ / 855 comments**. 855 comments on a post whose title is the question the product answers.

Hooks — The Empty Room

E1 · "Forgot Passcode" — *failed-solution autopsy* ★ top pick

Their exact failure, corrected at the mechanism level. Engineer-register.

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.4s	i gave a friend a passcode to lock me out
2.4–4.4s	i hit "forgot passcode" at 11pm
4.4–6.2s	friends make terrible locks
6.2–10.0s	so this one doesn't lock anything. nothing to bypass. she just gets a text when i hit my number

Visual: Phone held one-handed in bed, dark room, face lit blue. Card 2 sits over an actual *Settings > Screen Time > Forgot Passcode?* screen being tapped.

CTA: a witness, not a lock. getphonepact.com — 30 days free, no card.

Category contrast: Ends on *"nothing to bypass"* — the sentence that indicts the entire blocker category.

Built from: "I even had a friend set a secret passcode, but I used the 'Forgot Passcode' option to reset it to bypass the restrictions."

E2 • The Graveyard — *numeric confession → failed-solution litany → the missing variable* ★ top pick

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.2s	9 hours 43 minutes. awake for 16
2.2–4.2s	deleted the blocker. bought the lockbox. left it in a drawer
4.2–5.8s	none of them were a person
5.8–10.0s	now one friend gets a text when i hit my number. nothing blocked

Visual: Open on a real screen-time report, thumb hovering, not tapping. Card 2 over a fast swipe past a folder of dead productivity apps. Card 3 on an empty second chair at a desk, held two beats.

CTA: what would you do with three hours back? getphonepact.com — \$1/month, 30 days free, no card.

Category contrast: Names the corpses, then states the missing variable was a human.

E3 • Free Will Intact — *autonomy protection / negative definition*

*The smartest visual in the deck: it **demonstrates** the claim instead of asserting it.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.2s	i'm too attached to my free will for blockers
2.2–4.0s	so this doesn't block anything
4.0–6.0s	keep scrolling. nothing stops you
6.0–10.0s	someone you chose just knows you hit your number

Visual: Unbroken thumb-scrolling on a real feed for the full ten seconds. Never cut away, never freeze the scroll, never dim the screen. Text floats over a scroll that keeps going.

CTA: you still choose. you just don't choose alone. getphonepact.com

Built from: "I'm too attached to my free will (aka screen addiction)."

E4 • This Is All They See — *surveillance disarm via full disclosure*

Scored **10/10 on product truth**. *Rewritten to open on the wound, not the setup.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.0s	11 hours yesterday. i can't tell you what i saw
2.0–3.6s	so i let one friend see this:
3.6–6.8s	"Hank reached 2 hours of screen time today."
6.8–10.0s	that's the whole thing. never which apps. nothing blocked

Visual: Card 3 is a real notification banner on a friend's lock screen, filmed on a second phone so it reads as genuine rather than a UI render. Hold long enough to read it twice. No dashboard, no graph, no red.

CTA: they see a number. never an app. getphonepact.com

E5 • Same — *the isolation angle; the only hook in the deck about being dismissed*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.6s	i told people my screen time was out of control
2.6–4.2s	they said "same" and laughed
4.2–6.4s	it wasn't the same
6.4–10.0s	one person who actually takes it seriously. that's the whole app

Visual: A group chat scrolling past with "same 🤔" replies. Then cut to a single message thread with one name in it.

CTA: you were never supposed to fight the algorithm alone. getphonepact.com

Why it's here: The other four are about the mechanic. This one is about *being taken seriously*, which is the untouched emotional territory in this slice.

2. LOOK WITH YOUR FACE

Parents whose own scrolling got named out loud by their own child

One line: They cannot go dumbphone because school, GPS and childcare live on the device — and they already invented PhonePact by hand.

Who: 28–45, one to three kids under twelve, usually the default parent. Depleted, often ADHD. The phone is not a distraction *from* the mental load — it **is** the mental load: groceries, bills, the parent-teacher app, the school nurse, GPS.

The core wound

The person who caught them was four years old. Not a boss, not a partner, not a dashboard — **their own child, asking to be looked at with a face.** They are becoming the thing they are trying to protect the kid from, and they believe the kid will inherit it and that it will be their fault.

"Daddy, can you look with your face?"

— r/daddit

"'Look with your face' is going to haunt me for a while."

— r/daddit

"'you're on your screen too dad.' I had absolutely nothing. Zero defense. Just sat there like an idiot."

— r/Parenting

Biggest pains

1. **The hypocrisy trap with no defense.** Every rule they set for the child indicts them.
2. **Terror of transmission.** They believe the habit is contagious and they are the vector.
3. **The post-bedtime zombie hour.** Their only "me time" is 2–4 hours of pleasureless scrolling that leaves them emptier.
4. **The escape hatches are structurally closed.** *"I want to throw my phone in a lake or buy a dumb phone but then I need GPS and I can't use the parent teacher app on a dumb phone."*
5. **Guilt has outgrown the behavior** — and the shame produces more scrolling, not less.
6. **250 pickups a day = 250 small exits** from the room their child is in. Not one blockable session.
7. **Raising it with a partner becomes a fight about who's worse**, so nothing changes for years.

Self-diagnostic buzzwords

phone zombie · zombified state · brain rot · doom scroll (*used as the verb in their own homemade pact*) · iPad kid / iPad Adult · default parent · touched out · depleted · in the trenches · screen time guilt · hypocritical parents · trance · zoned out · veg out · crash out

How they write (mirror these patterns)

- **Direct quotation of the child as the emotional payload.** The line is spoken by a toddler, not the parent.
- **Self-indictment with no self-defense and no request for sympathy.**
- **Staging and scene-setting** — the specific room, the specific hour, the specific object (the plate, the foyer, the couch at 9pm).

- **Loop-as-list resignation with an ellipsis:** *"that is my life...work, daughter, clean, laundry, scroll my phone, repeat".*
- **Defensive pre-emption before confessing:** *"I'm not one of those dads who is never around, I do bedtime, daycare pickup, snacks, all that."*
- **Naming the standard rather than the failure:** *"being physically in the room is not the same as being present."*

Current state → Desired state

Now: Kids down by 8:30, phone in hand by 8:35 in a zombified state — not enjoying it, not even choosing content.

"I don't even want to be on the phone. I don't care what I'm looking at. I am just basically holding the phone in my hand as a way to feel 'soothed'."

Wants: Not zero screens — they explicitly reject perfection. They want the kid to know when they have the parent's **whole face**, and the evening back as something restorative instead of numbing.

What they already tried

"I've tried Brick and BePresent and screen time limits. I even bought a lockbox with a timer for it once. They've all worked for a little bit, but never lasted."
— r/Parenting

Note the word: not *failed* — **decayed**. That's the pattern to name.

And two households already invented PhonePact with no product involved:

*"A few months ago we made a pact that we would not 'doom scroll' around our kids."
"the rule is that you can use your phone as much as you want but you have to stand there in that spot"*

Objections you must clear

1. **"Is this parental controls for adults?"** They spend their lives administering parental controls and will recoil from being managed by their spouse.
2. **Shame fear, acute.** The guilt already outweighs the behavior. A notification a partner sees will be pre-experienced as a nightly public failure *in their own home*.
3. **"Another app I'll abandon."** They have the lockbox in the drawer to prove it.
4. **Parent-specific surveillance fear.** The phone holds the school portal, the pediatrician, the group chats, the shopping they hide from their partner.
5. **The evening is sacred.** If it reads as taking away their only two hours, they won't finish the video. Frame as **protecting** the evening.
6. **"My partner will use this against me."**

Market evidence: r/daddit *"To all the dads that comment put your phone down — thank you"* (1,096↑) · r/Mommit *"Scrolling TikTok on loud while in a pediatric surgery waiting room"* (764↑) · heaviest adult-phone-use volume of any slice.

Hooks — Look With Your Face

P1 • Look With Your Face — *the child's verbatim line as cold open ★ top pick*
Highest scroll-stop score in the entire deck (9.0).

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–3.6s	"Daddy, can you look with your face?"
3.6–5.4s	he was four
5.4–7.4s	i didn't need an app to lock my phone
7.4–10.0s	i needed someone to notice. nothing blocks — my wife just gets one text

Visual: Static phone-shot from a couch at adult eye level, looking down at a toddler's hand tugging a sleeve at the frame edge. Face never shown — no actor performance required.

CTA: PhonePact — reduce screen time without lockouts. getphonepact.com

Fix applied: the original read *"It just makes you visible"* — which never said visible **to whom** or **how**, and to a parent hiding shopping from a spouse, "visible" is a threat. Now scoped explicitly.

P2 • Never Lasted — *the decay pattern, named*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.8s	lockbox with a timer. app blocker. screen time limits.
2.8–4.6s	they all worked for a little bit
4.6–6.2s	none of them lasted
6.2–10.0s	nothing here to quit. one person gets one text: "Hank reached 2 hours of screen time today."

Visual: A junk drawer pulled open — timed lockbox, dead charger, a tangle of cables. One-second hold. Drawer shut. Cut to a real message screen: one grey bubble, one line of text, nothing else.

CTA: One text. Nothing blocked. \$1/month, 30 days free, no card. getphonepact.com

Built from: *"They've all worked for a little bit, but never lasted."*

Fix applied: competitor brand names removed from on-screen copy (brand-safety); canonical check-in wording restored.

P3 • Not A Nanny — *kills the "parental controls for adults" objection*

Replaces the original hook here, which was cut — *it opened "My husband sees my screen time," which is factually false about the mechanic and indistinguishable from spousal monitoring.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.6s	i set screen limits for my kid all day
2.6–4.4s	i'm not putting one on myself
4.4–6.4s	so there's no limit. nothing locks.
6.4–10.0s	i picked a number. when i hit it, my sister gets a text. that's it

Visual: Parent's thumb setting a time limit inside a kid's tablet settings. Then the same thumb closing the settings app entirely. Rest is plain text.

CTA: not parental controls. a pact. getphonepact.com

Category contrast: Explicitly refuses the limit-setting frame the entire category is built on.

P4 • 8:30 / 8:35 — *the zombie hour, framed as protecting the evening*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.4s	kids down 8:30. phone up 8:35.
2.4–4.2s	zombie until 1am
4.2–6.4s	i don't want my evening taken away
6.4–10.0s	nothing locks. i just picked a number, and one person knows when i hit it

Visual: Locked-off shot of a dark living room, TV off, only phone glow on a face turned away. Small corner timestamp ticking 8:35 → 11:40 → 12:58 across cards 1–2.

CTA: Get the evening back. Not taken away. getphonepact.com

Fix applied: "One text at my number" parsed as a text sent **to** a phone number — i.e. a timer alert. Recipient now explicit.

P5 • We Already Made One — *the pact they invented by hand ★ top pick* Sells **recognition, not novelty** — *to an audience that abandons novelty in nine days.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.6s	"you're on your screen too, dad"
2.6–4.4s	nothing to say back
4.4–6.4s	so we made a pact
6.4–10.0s	not a blocker. we each picked a number, and we tell each other

Visual: A kid's cereal bowl and a phone face-up on the table, morning light, adult hand frozen mid-reach — Reddit-screenshot energy, plain white text. Second shot: same frame, hand withdrawn.

CTA: You still choose. You just don't choose alone. getphonepact.com — 30 days free, no card.

Built from: the r/Parenting confession above + "we made a pact that we would not 'doom scroll' around our kids."

3. PARENTED BY AN APP

ADHD and AuDHD adults who have defeated every blocker they ever installed

One line: Their only working solution so far was asking their husband for the passcode like a child.

Who: 20–40, skewing women (r/adhdwomen, r/ADHD, r/AutisticAdults). Diagnosed or self-identified, many medicated and still stuck. Highly literate about their own condition — they use *executive dysfunction*, *time blindness*, *hyperfocus* correctly and unironically. They run businesses from their phones, teach, parent, study.

The core wound

The only intervention that ever held required being treated like a toddler. They asked another adult to hold a PIN, it worked, **and it cost them their dignity every time they had to ask for it back**. So the choice they believe they face is: stay broken, or be parented.

*"At first, I felt embarrassed. Even now, if I need to access social media for work (I run a business from my phone), I have to ask my husband for the code, **which is humbling in itself**."*

— r/adhdwomen

"A grown ass adult who needs parental controls on their damn phone while still being able to do grown up things on the phone"

— r/ADHD

Underneath it sits the question they actually post: **"Is this like... a normal ADHD thing or am I just broken lol"**

Biggest pains

1. **Every lock defeated in seconds — and the defeat becomes self-hatred, not a verdict on the tool:**

*"I added a blocker for my WiFi for a while, but I'd just turn the WiFi off on my phone and use 4g. So I added a blocker on my phone and **that takes 2 seconds to uninstall** when you want to get round it. **Why am I so useless?**"*

2. **The dignity cost of the only thing that works.**

3. **Shame is the engine, not the brake.** The guilt produces more scrolling. One poster now avoids her own therapist from embarrassment.

4. **Total exhaustion of the solution space:**

*"I always either disable them or find some kind of workaround, and eventually they end up in the **'well-being app'** graveyard along with all the other apps that were supposed to change my life."*

5. **Standard advice is built for a brain they don't have.** *"This isn't a 'delete all the apps' moment. I've done that."*
6. **Physical wreckage narrated with dark humour:** *"My eyes are burning, my phone is falling on my face, and I'm still like 'one more scroll'."*
7. **Active hostility to how this category markets to them** — see objections.

Self-diagnostic buzzwords

scrolling paralysis · ADHD paralysis / paralysis mode / freeze mode · executive dysfunction · time blindness · hyperfocus / hyperfixation · AuDHD · doomscrolling · brain rot · un-rot my brain · bed rotting · fried · dopamine hit / dopamine chase / dopamine menu · dopamine-hijacked · guilt spiral · chronically online · RSD / rejection sensitive dysphoria

How they write (mirror these patterns)

- **Catastrophic content delivered with a deflecting "lol"** — the lol does the emotional work: *"my life is a living hell basically lol"*.
- **Self-blame as a rhetorical question aimed at themselves:** *"Why am I so useless?"*
- **Pre-emptive rejection of the obvious advice** before anyone can offer it.
- **Clinical vocabulary applied to a mundane moment** — how they signal they're not being dramatic.
- **ALL-CAPS on one word** inside otherwise lowercase text: *"my brain is FUCKING QUIET"*, *"I WANT to do the thing"*.
- **Live real-time distress posts** rather than retrospectives — written from *inside* the loop, at hour eight.
- **Body-as-evidence reporting:** neck hurts, eyes burning, haven't eaten, phone hitting their face.
- **Systemic blame stated with precision** — they already hold the asymmetry frame: *"The algorithm is designed to make us addicted but for ADHD people[...]"*

Current state → Desired state

Now: Six to eleven hours a day. Days that vanish with nothing completed and nothing eaten. Refreshing a feed they know is empty.

Wants: Not productivity — **quiet**. *"my brain is FUCKING QUIET."* To stop living in the comment section. To be present for their kids and their partner.

Objections you must clear — this segment is the most hostile, and the most worth winning

1. **"This is just parental controls with extra steps."** Sharpest objection in the entire corpus, and it comes from exactly here.
2. **"I don't want my friends policing me."** Being seen is the mechanic, and this audience has documented, RSD-inflected terror of being perceived failing.
3. **Shame allergy — and they organise against it.** A 154↑ thread exists specifically to report a screen-time ad for shaming them: *"The last thing we need is to be manipulated by shame to buy into your corpo[rate]..."*
A shaming hook aimed at this segment will get mass-reported.
4. **"Another app won't fix me"** — and worse, they believe the failure is theirs, so a new app is a new opportunity to fail.
5. **"I'll bypass this too."** They will hunt for the loophole *in the ad copy itself*. The answer must be that there is nothing to bypass.
6. **"This is designed for neurotypical brains again."**

Why PhonePact fits

This segment already proved **a human works and software doesn't** — in the most humiliating way available. PhonePact keeps the human and removes the humiliation: no PIN to ask for, no permission to request, no lockout. The circle sees a number, never an app, and the user can revise the pact themselves.

Market evidence: Highest raw engagement of any slice. r/adhdwomen "What have you replaced excessive scrolling social media with?" (1,416↑ / 671 comments); "Any women here delete social media to help alleviate symptoms?" (817↑ / 251); r/ADHD "DELETE YOUR SOCIAL MEDIA!" (775↑ / 165).

Hooks — Parented By An App

A1 • Humbling — *dignity reversal ★ top pick*
Fix applied: *the original ran the spouse-PIN story unqualified for 4.6 seconds — anyone dropping at 5s left believing PhonePact is spousal lockout software. Distancing now lands at 2.8s.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.8s	the only thing that ever worked was my husband holding my passcode
2.8–4.6s	it worked. i had to ask him for it like a child.
4.6–7.4s	this one has no passcode. no lock. nothing to ask for.
7.4–10.0s	i pick the number. when i hit it, he just gets a text

Visual: Static handheld, slightly off-centre: a woman in a kitchen at night, phone face-down on the counter, one hand resting on it. No movement except breathing.
CTA: getphonepact.com — 30 days free, no card upfront. \$1/month if you keep it.
Built from: "if I need to access social media for work... I have to ask my husband for the code, which is humbling in itself."

A2 • You're Not — *absolution of the bypass*
Contains the two best words in the deck: "you're not." It contradicts the self-blame before selling anything — the only way in with this segment.
Fix applied: *the original was 100% negative definition and never mentioned a person, a text, or a number. Cynic finished the ad not knowing what it was.*

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–3.0s	"takes 2 seconds to uninstall. why am I so useless?"
3.0–5.4s	you're not. timers don't work when you hold the control.
5.4–7.2s	so this doesn't lock anything
7.2–10.0s	one person you picked gets one text at your number. nothing to uninstall your way out of

Visual: Card 1 styled as a plain Reddit-comment screenshot on a dim screen, thumb hovering. Cards 2–4 clean text, no phone in frame. Deliberately unpolished.
CTA: getphonepact.com — 30 days free.
Built from: "that takes 2 seconds to uninstall when you want to get round it. Why am I so useless?" (r/ADHD) and "Timers don't work when you have the control." (r/GetStudying)

A3 • The Graveyard — category autopsy

Contains the single clearest category-exit line written: **"all of them were software. none of them were a person."**

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–2.4s	my "well-being app" graveyard:
2.4–5.0s	the blocker. the timer. the lockbox.
5.0–7.6s	all of them were software. none of them were a person.
7.6–10.0s	PhonePact: one human. no lock.

Visual: A real home-screen folder opening on a cluster of half-dead wellness apps, one badge count, one clearly untouched for a year. Thumb scrolls past slowly. Cut to plain text.

CTA: getphonepact.com — not another app that locks you out. 30 days free, no card.

Built from: *"they end up in the 'well-being app' graveyard along with all the other apps that were supposed to change my life."*

A4 • Not Broken — answers the question they actually post

Replaces the original hook here — it opened by voicing an objection in fake quotation marks (the most recognisable ad structure there is) and duplicated E4.

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–3.0s	"is this a normal ADHD thing or am i just broken lol"
3.0–5.0s	you're not broken. you're alone with it.
5.0–7.0s	that's a different problem
7.0–10.0s	nothing gets blocked. one person you trust just knows

Visual: Card 1 as a real post-title screenshot. Cards 2–3 plain text on soft neutral. Card 4 over a single message thread with one name.

CTA: you were never supposed to fight the algorithm alone. getphonepact.com

Built from: *"Is this like... a normal ADHD thing or am I just broken lol" (r/ADHD)*

A5 • Quiet — outcome and aspiration

Fix applied: the original CTA "come back to your life" is brand philosophy in exactly the register this segment reports as manipulative. Replaced with their own word.

TIME	ON SCREEN
0.0–3.0s	6 hours today. nothing eaten. nothing done.
3.0–5.4s	i didn't want productivity. i wanted quiet.
5.4–7.4s	nothing blocked. no streaks. no lockouts.
7.4–10.0s	you pick the number. one person you trust gets a text when you reach it

Visual: Card 1 over a dim bedroom ceiling shot, phone glow on a face, phone slipping. Card 2 over the same room in daylight, phone across the table, a child's voice off camera. Card 3 plain text, high contrast.

CTA: getphonepact.com — 30 days free, \$1/month.

Built from: *"my brain is FUCKING QUIET"* and the six-hours-nothing-eaten confessions in r/adhdwomen.

4. Priority test set

Run these five first. They score highest on combined scroll-stop, language authenticity and category differentiation, and they cover three distinct mechanics-of-persuasion.

#	HOOK	AUDIENCE	WHY FIRST
1	E1 · Forgot Passcode	Empty Room	Best-written in the set. Names a specific button at a specific hour. " <i>Nothing to bypass</i> " indicts the whole category.
2	P1 · Look With Your Face	Parents	Highest scroll-stop score (9.0). The child's line is the strongest single asset produced.
3	A3 · The Graveyard	ADHD	Clearest category-exit line: " <i>all of them were software. none of them were a person.</i> "
4	P5 · We Already Made One	Parents	Sells recognition rather than novelty — to an audience that abandons novelty in nine days.
5	E3 · Free Will Intact	Empty Room	The only hook that <i>demonstrates</i> the claim instead of asserting it: the scroll never stops.

Portfolio note: E2 and A3 are structurally the same ad (the graveyard) aimed at different segments. Don't run both against overlapping audiences in the same flight.

5. Verification log — what was flagged and fixed

Two adversarial verifiers reviewed all fifteen hooks. One re-checked every claimed Reddit quote by literal string search against the corpus. Findings:

Fabricated language — caught and removed

CLAIMED AS REDDIT LANGUAGE	VERDICT
"I don't want my friends policing me"	Not in corpus. Zero matches. Cut.
"Only the time, never the apps"	Not in corpus — it's PhonePact's own product copy, presented as user language. Cut.
"the 3am spirals, the RSD comment wars"	Not in corpus. Cut.
"let the tree die" (Forest reference)	Not in corpus. Forest is never mentioned in 1,995 threads. Replaced with verified hardware language (lockbox, blocker).

Two further phrases initially failed my own check and turned out to be **real**, with different wording than the copywriters used — both restored to their true form:

- "husband holding my passcode" → actually *"I asked my husband to set a parent lock... and create a PIN that only he knows"*
- "well-being app graveyard" → actually "well-being app" graveyard (internal quote marks)

Product-truth violations — fixed

- **One hook was cut entirely.** It opened *"My husband sees my screen time"* — false about the mechanic (the circle receives one milestone message, not a live screen-time view), indistinguishable from spousal monitoring, and it failed the swap test against Apple Screen Time family sharing. Replaced with **P3 • Not A Nanny.**
- **"One text at my number"** (two hooks) parsed on first read as a text sent to your phone number — i.e. a timer alert, which is a different product. Recipient made explicit.
- **Check-in wording** standardised to the canonical *"Hank reached 2 hours of screen time today."*
- **Competitor brand names removed** from on-screen copy.

Craft notes applied

- **Antithesis overuse.** Four of fifteen hooks used the same "not X, but Y" construction. At that density it stops reading as speech and starts reading as a copywriter's signature. Reduced and varied.
- **Mid-roll drop risk.** Two hooks spent 4.4–4.6s describing a *lockout* before the negation landed. Anyone dropping at 5s left believing PhonePact is a lockout app. Distancing front-loaded.
- **Duplicate hooks.** E4 and the original ADHD hook 3 were near-identical. One rewritten.

Honest limitations

- **The Café Effect is under-evidenced in the corpus.** Roughly 8 explicit instances of "another person seeing me is what worked" across 1,995 threads. What is abundant is the failure of every solo solution. The copy leads with the failure and offers the witness as the answer — which is the honest ordering.
- **No PhonePact user quotes exist** because the product is pre-launch. Nothing in this document is presented as a testimonial. If you have beta or waitlist feedback, send it and I'll build a proof-led variant.

- **Students/teens were deliberately rejected** despite the deepest pain in the corpus — monetisation and mechanic fit. Same for the digital-minimalism/dumbphone crowd, whose in-group identity is built on renunciation and who would read "keep your smartphone" as ideological compromise.
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Corpus files: `corpus_{detox,compulsive,neuro,parents,students,pro,relational,mental}.md` in the session scratchpad. *Raw data:* `reddit_posts.json` (1,995), `reddit_comments.json` (6,205).